

UNITED NATIONS DEPOSITORY EDITION

INTERNATIONAL CHARTER FOR THE RECOGNITION AND PROTECTION OF NON-HUMAN LIVING BEINGS

(Submitted through the Hon'ble President of the Republic of India under Article 51(c) of the Constitution of India).

Reference Case: VOICELESSBEINGS/IN/INDIA2025

Case Number: 1740/30/1/2025

Date of Registration: 05 June 2025

Registered by: National Human Rights Commission (NHRC), New Delhi

This Charter forms the international legal continuation and moral expansion of the Voiceless Beings India 2025 Case.

PREAMBLE

Guided by the principles enshrined in the Charter of the United Nations (1945), recalling the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (1948) and reaffirming the Vienna Convention on the Law of Treaties (1969), this Charter recognizes that peace, morality, and justice must extend beyond humanity to include every form of life — living and non-living — that shares existence on Earth.

Once, the world resounded with natural harmony: the koel's song, the peacock's dance, the lion's roar, the rustle of leaves, and the rhythm of the oceans — all interwoven in the divine balance of life. Over time, humankind's actions have shattered this harmony, enslaving species, destroying habitats, and commodifying life for pleasure and profit. Killing, exploitation, and captivity of sentient beings have been normalized, betraying the universal duty of compassion.

Every living being — whether it flies in the sky, swims in the sea, creeps upon the earth, or stands rooted in silence — was granted by nature the sacred right to live peacefully and continue its lineage. No life is superior or inferior. True civilization begins only when humanity recognizes and respects the emotions, pain, and dignity of non-human life.

Therefore, this Charter solemnly declares that:

- Exploitation, commodification, and entertainment-based cruelty toward non-human beings are incompatible with global ethics and international human rights.

- Cultural, religious, or economic justifications cannot excuse the infliction of suffering, the killing of beings for ornaments, or the treatment of life as property.
- The terminology and institutions that reduce the dignity of animals — such as labelling them as “pets” or “exhibits” — must be reformed to affirm respect and legal protection.

This Charter calls upon all nations to:

- Prohibit the trade, ownership, or use of living beings for gambling, sport, or luxury;
- Ban the killing or trading of any being for jewellery, trophies, or rituals;
- Recognize food and habitat security for non-human species as a global moral and legal duty;
- Establish national and international monitoring mechanisms for welfare, ethics, and humane coexistence.

For enforcement, this Charter proposes the creation of an **Independent International Council for Non-Human Justice (ICNHJ)** — a judicial and oversight body empowered to investigate violations, ensure reparations, and coordinate cross-border cooperation for the protection of voiceless beings.

Guided by **Aram (Moral Righteousness)** and the eternal duty to preserve the continuity of all life, we submit this Charter through the *President of the Republic of India* to the *United Nations and its Member States*, urging the recognition of non-human life as an equal subject of peace, justice, and moral law.

ARTICLES

Article 1 – Purpose and Scope

This Charter establishes a universal legal and moral framework for the recognition, protection, and continuity of all non-human living beings, including animals, birds, aquatic life, insects, and all silent life-forms that share the biosphere with humankind.

Article 2 – Legal Recognition of Sentience

All non-human beings capable of perceiving pain, pleasure, emotion, or distress are hereby recognized as sentient entities entitled to protection under

international law. Their sentence shall inform all legislative, administrative, and judicial actions of States Parties.

Article 3 – Principle of Moral Equality

No species shall be deemed superior or inferior by virtue of origin, intelligence, or usefulness to humankind. Every form of life has intrinsic moral worth and the natural right to exist, evolve, and flourish within its ecosystem.

Article 4 – Prohibition of Exploitation and Commodification

States Parties shall prohibit all acts that enslave, trade, or use non-human beings for financial, entertainment, experimental, or ornamental purposes. Commerce in live beings and their derivatives shall be outlawed except for verified humane conservation or rescue purposes.

Article 5 – Cultural and Religious Practices

No cultural, ritual, or religious justification shall be accepted for practices that cause suffering or death to sentient beings. All traditions shall evolve in harmony with **Aram – Moral Righteousness** to reflect compassion and justice toward life.

Article 6 – Habitat and Food Security

Each nation shall ensure protected habitats, natural migration routes, and sustainable food access for non-human species. Destruction of habitats for industrial or military purposes shall be considered a violation of this Charter.

Article 7 – Scientific and Ethical Oversight

Any research or scientific procedure involving living beings must be conducted only under strict ethical review ensuring minimal harm, humane treatment, and transparent accountability consistent with the UNESCO Recommendation on the Ethics of AI (2021) and the World Animal Health Standards (OIE).

Article 8 – Prohibition of Cruel Entertainment and Trade

Circuses, blood sports, animal races, zoos operated for profit, and any form of gambling or exhibition exploiting living beings shall be prohibited. States Parties shall replace such practices with compassionate, educational, and digital alternatives.

Article 9 – Economic and Policy Integration

Member States shall integrate non-human protection metrics into national economic planning and sustainability indices. Trade policies that depend upon animal exploitation shall be restructured toward humane, plant-based, and renewable industries.

Article 10 – International Monitoring and Justice

An **Independent International Council for Non-Human Justice (ICNHJ)** shall be established under the United Nations system to monitor compliance, investigate violations, issue binding recommendations, and coordinate reparative actions across borders.

Article 11 – Education and Cultural Transformation

States Parties shall promote education and awareness programs to instill compassion, coexistence, and respect for all forms of life. Educational curricula worldwide shall incorporate moral philosophy (Aram) and scientific understanding of sentience.

Article 12 – Implementation and Review

This Charter shall enter into moral and diplomatic force upon its transmission to the United Nations Secretariat. A global review conference shall be convened every five years to assess compliance, recommend reforms, and ensure continuity of life as the supreme principle of civilization.

CONCLUSION

Guided by Aram (Moral Righteousness) and inspired by the eternal duty to protect all life, this Charter is respectfully submitted through the Hon'ble President of India to the United Nations, UNESCO, UNEP, and OHCHR for universal adoption and entry into the records of international law.

Issued and authored by

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